INCH-POUND

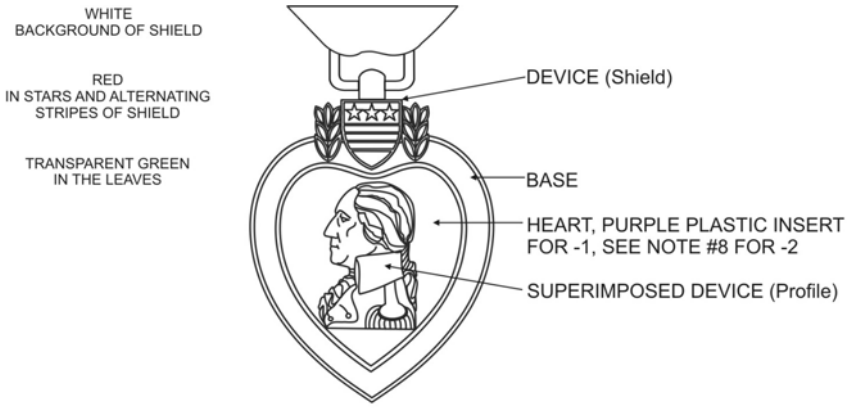
MIL-DTL-3943/24J
20 November 2007
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-3943/24G
10 September 2007

DETAIL SPECIFICATION SHEET

DECORATION, PURPLE HEART

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and the latest issue of MIL-DTL-3943.



OBVERSE



REVERSE

DASH NO:
-1: Regular Size
-2: Miniature Size

MATERIAL:

BASE: Gilding Metal
DEVICE (Shield): Gilding Metal
DEVICE (Profile): Red Brass
HEART INSERT -1: Purple Plastic
-2: Purple Plastic or Enamel

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FINISH:

BASE: Hard Enameled, Gold Plated, Matte Finish and shall match The Institute of Heraldry (TIOH) Metal Finish Chip Number 7.
DEVICE (shield): Hard Enameled, Gold Plated, Matte Finish and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 7.
DEVICE (profile): Gold Plated, Matte Finish and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 7.
HEART INSERT: Mirror-like Polished.

DIMENSIONS:

BASE:
HEIGHT:
-1 (including lug): 1-7/8 inches (REF)
-2 (including lug and pendant ribbon ring): 29/32 inch (REF)
WIDTH (overall):
-1: 1-3/8 inches (REF)
-2: 3/4 inch (REF)
THICKNESS:
-1: (on profile platform): 0.160 inch ± 0.005 inch
-2: (on shield): 0.110 inch ± 0.005 inch

DEVICE (shield):
HEIGHT (overall)
-1: 3/8 inch (REF)
WIDTH (overall):
-1: 5/16 inch (REF)
THICKNESS (at thickest point):
-1: 0.031 inch ± 0.005 inch

DEVICE (profile):
HEIGHT (overall):
-1: 13/16 inch (REF)
-2: 11/32 inch (REF)
WIDTH (overall):
-1: 9/16 inch (REF)
-2: 1/4 inch (REF)
THICKNESS (at thickest point)
-1: 0.070 inch ± 0.005 inch
-2: 0.055 inch ± 0.005 inch

PLASTIC INSERT:
HEIGHT:
-1: 1-3/32 inches (REF)
-2: 9/16 inch (REF)
THICKNESS (minimum at center):
-1: 0.055 inch ± 0.005 inch tapering at edge to 0.020 inch maximum
-2: 0.055 inch ± 0.005 inch

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

WIDTH (overall):
-1: 1 inch (REF)
-2: 1/2 inch (REF)

ASSEMBLED THICKNESS:
-1: 0.230 inch ± 0.010 inch
-2: 0.225 inch ± 0.010 inch

NOTES:

1. The term (REF) refers to the measurements taken from the Government furnished hub or die.

2. Profile device shall be attached to the base by means of two drive pins having a minimum length of 1/8 inch. Drive pins shall be located on the vertical center line of the device, equidistant from each end and shall be soldered, swaged or extruded as an integral part of the profile. Drive pins shall not protrude or be noticeable on reverse of medal.

3. The shield device enameled/epoxied areas shall be as shown. Epoxy resin (stoning epoxy) may be used at the option of the manufacturer. When hard enamel is used, the material requirement shall be gilding metal. When epoxy is used, the material requirement shall be either red brass or gilding material. Colors shall conform to TIOH Hard Enamel Color Chip Numbers listed below:

COLOR	CHIP NO.
Red	4
Green	11
White	28

4. The shield device shall be attached to the base using soft solder.

5. The shield device for Dash No. -2 is an integral part of the base.

6. When glued in place, the color of the plastic insert shall match Purple, Cable No. HP 67115 from the Department of Defense Standard Shades of Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons (1993 Edition).

7. Plastic insert shall be glued in place using cellulose ester cement.

8. Enamel may be used in place of plastic insert for Dash No. -2. When hard enamel is used, the material requirement shall be gilding metal. Enamel color shall be purple and enamel color shall conform to TIOH Hard Enamel Color Chip Number 22.

9. Pendant ribbon ring for Dash No. -1 shall be formed from 0.57 inch ± .002 inch diameter brass wire and shall have a rectangular design and an outside dimension of 15/32 inch ± 1/32 inch in width and 11/32 inch ± 1/32 inch in height.

10. Lug for Dash No. -1 shall not be completely drilled through but shall be drilled in a minimum of 1/16 inch from each side. The hole shall be 1/16 inch + 1/32 inch -0 inch, in diameter.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

11. Decoration set shall consist of a regular size medal, a service ribbon, and a lapel button all packaged in a presentation case conforming to MIL-C-14633, Type VIII, Style 6 with a Class 1, 1A or 3 pad.

12. The ribbon for the pendant drape and service ribbon shall conform to MIL-DTL-11589/126.

13. The lapel button shall conform to MIL-DTL-11484/18.

CHANGES FROM PREVIOUS ISSUE: The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate where changes from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Air Force - 11
Navy - NU

Preparing activity:
Army - IH
(Project No. 8455-2008-034)

Review activities:
Air Force - 99
Navy - MC
Coast Guard - CG
DLA - CT

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at http://assist.daps.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:53Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.